

Qualcomm's Alex and Kedar Discuss AI Innovations and Snapdragon X Elite in Microsoft Partnership

In conversation with Qualcomm's Alex Katouzian, Group GM, Mobile, Compute, & XR (MCX), and Kedar Kondap, SVP and GM, Compute & Gaming

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In this interview, we speak with Qualcomm's Alex Katouzian, Group General Manager, Mobile, Compute, & XR (MCX), Qualcomm and Kedar Kondap, SVP and GM, Compute and Gaming, Qualcomm about their exciting collaboration with Microsoft for the upcoming Windows release. They share insights into how the partnership is driving advancements in AI and the intelligent capabilities of the Snapdragon X Elite.

Digit: Regarding your collaboration with Microsoft regarding the next release of Windows, what excites you the most? Because we know there's going to be a lot of AI play and there's this new release that's also coming out around the same time. Is there something that you're really excited about?

Kedar: So you know for us, what we've announced with the Snapdragon X Elite, we focused on a couple of different vectors, right? First, we want to make sure that it is the best performing part in the market by far. Second, we make sure that we're the most efficient platform that you can ever find in this



Qualcomm's Alex Katouzian and Kedar Kondap

space. And third, the most important vector (that seems to be getting more and more attention) is that it's the most intelligent processor. So, I think a lot of work that we're doing is on making sure how we can drive that intelligence factor into something that consumers can understand. And all the work that we're doing and what we've announced even with the specs, like for example, we announced 45 TOPS. And the reason is because we've invested in AI for the last 10 years and we want to bring all the work that we've done and drive that to the Snapdragon X Elite. So the goal for us in working with Microsoft, is to drive a lot of use cases that will drive that differentiation. I think you've seen a lot of what they've announced starting (almost I think two years back) with they announced Windows Studio effects where they started to take advantage of a lot of the capabilities that we offer. So it's not just on the Snapdragon X Elite, but even on the previous generations of the platforms that Qualcomm announced. It started with simple things,

right? There's background blur, bokeh, eye gaze correction, etc. A lot of these features seem natural to a user, especially more so during the last couple years when we all were on video calls. Then there's the feature which automatically recognizes voices around and suppresses noise. But the point is, with a Qualcomm Snapdragon based platform, we were able to run it on an MPU. What that means is that it translates into substantially lower power because when you're on a video call, we run in a heterogeneous system so a lot of the use cases that Microsoft has, for example with the Windows Studio effects we run them in a much lower power state. So, there's a lot of work happening and we're super excited about the partnership with Microsoft.

Digit: Now, quite a lot of features within Windows Studio Effects tend to be 'good to have' rather than being game changers. For example, let's say if you have a big office and you have a lot of folks working